

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	30 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-2683
Project Name	Script-Controlled ACL: Record Access Control in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Team members: (add your team members' names here)

Problem statement (How Might We):

How might we restrict who can view, create, edit and delete records in ServiceNow, based on a user's role and branch, so sensitive data stays protected?

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstormed ideas (replace with your own team's ideas):

- Create separate roles for read, create, write and delete.
- Add a data condition so only EEE-branch records are visible.
- Write an ACL script that checks the user's branch against the record's branch.
- Add a branch field to the user record.
- Use groups (for example "EEE Faculty") instead of individual roles.
- Let admins bypass restrictions.
- Use Debug Security Rules to test access.
- Test everything with impersonation.
- Hide the New button from users without the create role.
- Add field-level ACLs for sensitive fields such as phone and email.

Grouped ideas (cluster labels):

1. **Access is split into separate role-based permissions.** Roles per operation, groups instead of roles, admin override.
2. **Access depends on the record and the user.** Data condition, branch check in the script, branch field on the user.
3. **Access must be tested and verified.** Impersonation, Debug Security Rules, hiding the New button.
4. **Sensitive data needs extra protection.** Field-level ACLs.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Ideas placed by Importance and Feasibility:

Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Priority
Role per operation (read, create, write, delete)	High	High	Do first
Data condition on Branch	High	High	Do first
Script comparing user branch and record branch	High	Medium	Do next
Impersonation testing	High	High	Do first
Branch field on user	Medium	Medium	Do next
Field-level ACLs	Medium	Low	Later

The ideas in the high-importance, high-feasibility corner are the ones the team builds first.

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Define the Problem Statements

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Customer Problem Statement :

In educational institutions, student records held in ServiceNow contain sensitive information that only the right people should be able to view or change. At present, access is granted mainly by job role, and the system has no reliable way to tell which branch a user belongs to. As a result, a user with view permission can open another branch's records, while a genuine branch user such as an EEE faculty member cannot predict whether they are allowed to add, edit or delete records, because each action is granted through a separate role that is easy to miss.

Example:

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
a traveler	book flights on my phone	it takes a long time	the website is not responsive and doesn't have a mobile version	Frustrated

Our Problem Statements:

Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	a ServiceNow administrator at an educational institution	make sure each branch's staff can see only their own branch's student records	any user holding the read role can open EEE records, whatever their actual branch	the ACL checks only roles and has no link between a user and their branch	Worried that sensitive student data could be exposed
PS-2	an EEE faculty member using the Institution Details table	view, add, edit and delete the student records of my branch	the New button, edit and delete options appear or disappear unpredictably	each operation needs a separate role (read, create, write, delete) that must all be assigned together	Confused and frustrated

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Empathize & Discover

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Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes. It helps teams understand the true problem and the person experiencing it, from the user's own perspective, including their goals and challenges.

Empathy Map: EEE Faculty Member (Institution Details records)

Think & Feel • Am I allowed to change this record? • Worried about editing or deleting the wrong student's data • Wants to trust that only the right people can see student details • Frustrated when access changes without explanation		
Hear • Administrators say access depends on roles • Colleagues say they can see records they shouldn't, or can't see their own • The department says student data must stay private • "Ask the admin to give you access"	EEE Faculty Member <i>manages student records for their branch</i>	See • A student records list that shows only some records • The New button present for some colleagues and missing for others • Records from other branches appearing for some users
Say & Do • "Why can't I see the New button?" • Raises access requests with the administrator • Opens the records list directly to check what is visible • Asks a colleague to make edits on their behalf • Double-checks a record before saving changes		

Pain	Gain
• Unpredictable access to add, edit and delete records • Waiting on the administrator to fix access • Fear that student data is exposed to other branches • Not knowing why an action is blocked	• Clear, predictable access to their own branch's records • Sees only their branch's records • Confidence that student data is protected • Fewer access requests to the administrator

Note: the points above are the team's assumptions about the user and should be validated with real users.